Internationally Impactful Research:

Motivations and Challenges

Prof. Dr Rodrigo Leite

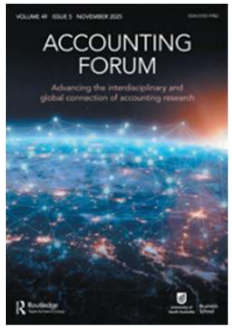
Assistant Professor of Finance
COPPEAD Graduate School of Business
The Federal University of Rio de Janeiro

A Brief Introduction

- BA in Accounting (Rio de Janeiro State University)
- MSc/PhD in Administration (EBAPE/FGV)
- Currently Assistant Professor of Finance at COPPEAD/UFRJ
- Previoulsy Assistant Professor of Accounting at UERJ (’16-’19)
- Published papers in Accounting, Finance, Economics and Math journals

Some of the outlets that I published in

- Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory (ABS 4)
- Journal of Business Ethics (ABS 3 & FT-50)
- International Journal of Accounting (ABS 3)
- Accounting Forum (ABS 3)
- Accounting, Auditing, and Accountability Journal (ABS 3)
- International Journal of Finance & Economics (ABS 3)
- Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions & Money (ABS 3)
- Finance Research Letters (ABS 2)
- International Review of Economics & Finance (ABS 2)
- Research in International Business & Finance (ABS 2)
- Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance (ABS 1)
- Research in Economics (ABS 1)
- Applied Economics Letters (ABS 1)
- Latin American Business Review (ABS 1)
- PLOS One



We are researchers

"A mathematician is a machine for turning coffee into theorems."
Alfréd Rényi (1921-1970)

You will turn coffee (or your choice of beverage) together with sweat and many many hours of work into papers. This is the core of our profession.

Mainstream quantitative SS is positive

- We believe that there is some objective truth.
- We as researchers try to guess what this truth may be.
- We then test to see if our guess aligns with data.
- We do that again, and again, and again, since we will never achieve this objective truth.

Relevance

- We always have to justify the relevance of our paper. If someone has published the same result before, so why bother to publish again what we already know?

- This is done together in the process of “guessing” the result, in what is called the literature review.

The guess

There are several types of guesses:

- You may guess that A causes B
- You may guess that A is related to B
- You may guess what conditions make B happen
- You may guess that the absence of A makes the effect of B on C smaller

- and so one and so forth...

The hypothesis

This guess is called an “hypothesis”. The hypotheses are the foundations upon which we build SS research.

Be careful

A hypothesis must be done *ex-ante* never *ex-post.*

Why you should not do an ex-post guess

You can tell anything with statistics!

Psychology Today

Michael L. Anderson Ph.D.
After Phrenology

Can Listening to the Beatles Reverse Aging?

Flexible data collection and analysis allows presenting anything as significant

Posted Dec 10, 2011

1

Study 2: musical contrast and chronological rejuvenation

Using the same method as in Study 1, we asked 20 University of Pennsylvania undergraduates to listen to either "When I'm Sixty-Four" by The Beatles or "Kalimba." Then, in an ostensibly unrelated task, they indicated their birth date (mm/dd/yyyy) and their father's age. We used father's age to control for variation in baseline age across participants.

An ANCOVA revealed the predicted effect: According to their birth dates, people were nearly a year-and-a-half younger after listening to "When I'm Sixty-Four" (adjusted $M = 20.1$ years) rather than to "Kalimba" (adjusted $M = 21.5$ years), $F(1, 17) = 4.92$, $p = .040$.

The consequences for that can be disastrous I

Retraction: Identity Threats, Compensatory Consumption, and Working Memory Capacity: How Feeling Threatened Leads to Heightened Evaluations of Identity-Relevant Products FREE

Journal of Consumer Research, ucaa033, https://doi.org/10.1093/jcr/ucaa033
Published: 03 July 2020

Retraction Watch

Consumer research study is retracted for unexplained anomalies

The consequences for that can be disastrous II

When contact changes minds

WIKIPEDIA
The Free Encyclopedia

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

"When contact changes minds: An experiment on transmission of support for gay equality" is a fraudulent article by then-UCLA political science graduate student Michael LaCour and Columbia University political science professor Donald Green. The article was published in the academic journal *Science* in December 2014, and retracted in May 2015 after it emerged that the data in the study had been forged by LaCour.[1] The article purported to demonstrate that people's minds on the issue of gay marriage could be changed by conversations with gay canvassers, but not with straight canvassers.

AAAS Become a Member

Science Contents News Careers Journals

Science retracts gay marriage paper without agreement of lead author LaCour

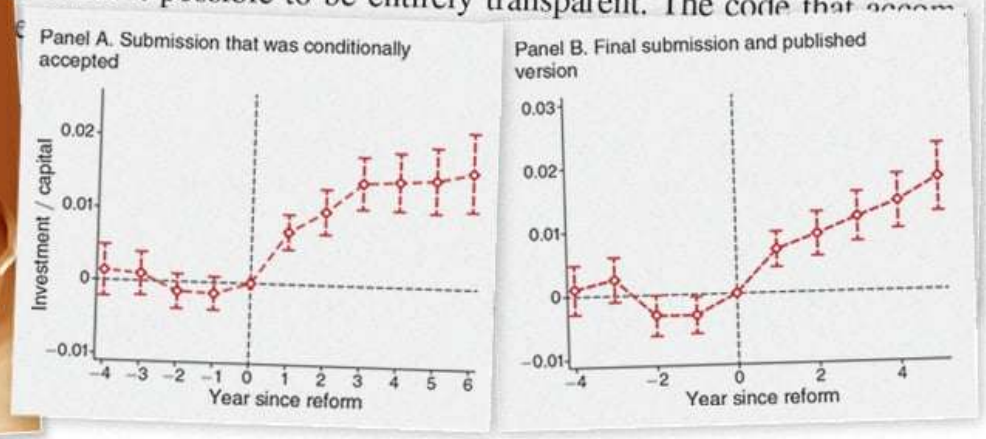
By John Bohannon | May. 28, 2015 , 2:00 PM

The consequences for that can be disastrous III

Retraction of "Dividend Taxes and the Allocation of Capital"†

By ADRIEN MATRAY AND CHARLES BOISSEL*

This notice explains the authors' reasons for retracting the published paper, Boissel and Matray (2022b). The authors are grateful for the data and code policies at the *AER* that make it possible to be entirely transparent. The code that accom



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Retraction of "Dividend Taxes and the Allocation of Capital"

Adrien Matray

Charles Boissel

AMERICAN ECONOMIC REVIEW
VOL. 113, NO. 7, JULY 2023
(pp. 2053–54)

The consequences for that can be disastrous IV

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

TECHNOLOGY | ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE Follow

MIT Says It No Longer Stands Behind Student's AI Research Paper

The university says it has no confidence in a widely circulated paper by an economics graduate student

By Justin Lahart Follow

May 16, 2025 9:46 am ET

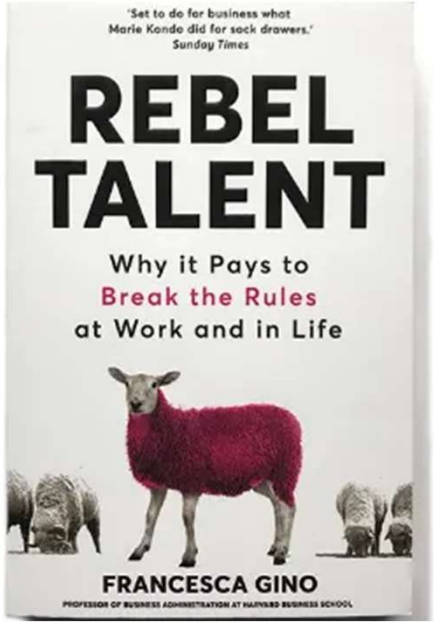
The Economist

Finance & economics | Sine laude

What the failure of a superstar student reveals about economics

Aidan Toner-Rodgers was enjoying a meteoric rise at MIT. Then questions started to be asked about his work

The consequences for that can be disastrous V



BREAKING: HBS professor placed on "administrative leave" following bombshell investigation into fake data

Harvard Business School professor of business administration Francesca Gino will have at least 4 of her papers retracted, "perhaps dozens"

FORBES > INNOVATION > SCIENCE

Harvard Honesty Researcher Accused of Plagiarism

Christian B. Miller Contributor

I write about issues at the intersection of ethics and psychology.

Follow

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Apr 15, 2024, 12:33pm EDT

Updated Apr 16, 2024, 08:42pm EDT

Another day, another academic researcher is being accused of dishonesty. In this case, it is Francesca Gino, recently the Tandon Family professor of business administration at Harvard Business School. The particular kind of dishonesty in question is plagiarism.

But why do people do stuff like that?

Huge incentives!

Do you know why top American universities such as Harvard, MIT, Yale, Stanford, etc. are respected?

Why are young universities such as HKUST or NUS are so well-regarded in the worldwide scenario?

Why are some Brazilian universities so well established internationally in the social sciences?

But why do people do stuff like that?

Because these universities publish in top journals.

Although this can be an inconvenient truth for most, what makes a good university is the ability to publish good papers. This builds the name of the university, which can sell that to students (get tuition), to the government (get grants) and to donors (get endowments).

But why do people do stuff like that?

Hence, in most universities, the professor must publish some good papers (the number depends on the university) in order to get tenure.

This created the academic motto of: “publish or perish”.

Most professors, if they do not publish enough, get fired after 5-9 years (depending on the tenure clock of the institution/department). This happens fairly frequently.

But why do people do stuff like that?

The livelihood of us, research professors, depend on the papers that we publish. Hence there is a lot of pressure on us to publish, and some may succumb to malpractice.

Our place in the pecking order of academia is determined by that.

That is the game that we play, but what are the rules of this game?

The paper

- Usually a manuscript is between 15 and 70 pages long (depending on the field, topic, target journal, etc)
- It starts with an abstract summarizing the research
- Then comes the Introduction, which usually displays the motivation, the gap in the literature that the paper is addressing, the research question and then the main results
- Most papers (again depending on the field, others prefer a larger introduction which encompasses this part) have a literature review describing the papers that deal with the same topic and what is the current gap in our knowledge and present the hypotheses, which are usually hinted from the literature
- Then we get to the methodological part, which includes the data, what are the statistical model that will be estimated, etc.
- We have the results of the estimations
- (Sometimes) some robustness check
- Papers usually finish with the concluding remarks

The paper (why follow this structure?)

This structure helps researchers to rapidly get all the important details and results of a paper without having to put a lot of time reading the paper.

Also, if researchers can easily read your paper, they can easily cite your paper. This leads us to the next point…

What are top journals?

Usually we want to have an impact on society. And, as researchers, we want to have an impact on academia. However, how can we quantify the impact?

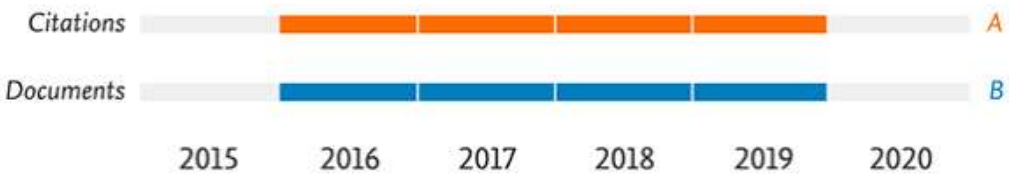
Current there are three ways:

- Impact factor (Clarivate)
- Citescore (Scopus)
- H-index (Scimago)

What are top journals?

Citescore

The new CiteScore formula:



$$\text{CiteScore 2019} = \frac{A}{B}$$

Numerator | Citations to articles, reviews, conference papers, book chapters and data papers published in 2016-2019

Denominator | Articles, reviews, conference papers, book chapters and data papers published in 2016-2019

What are top journals?

H-index

H-index tries to solve some of the problems:

*No intertemporal problems
*No “carriers”
*Fully free

What are top journals?

Other solutions to this problem: governmental lists

ABS (UK) [4, 4, 3, 2, 1]

ABDC (Australia) [A, A, B, C]

*CNRS (France) [1, 2, 3, 4]

ABS is the best (IMO) because it is mostly free of internal politics (French journals score way too high in the CNRS list, and Australian/New Zealand journals score way too high in ABDC lists).

Brazil has its list too (Qualis CAPES), which suffers from the same problems of the CNRS/ABDC lists. Our area will use ABS/ABDC in the next evaluation.

What are top journals?

ABS x IF

	ABS 1	ABS 2	ABS 3	ABS 4	ABS 4*
IF 2019	0.519	1.368	2.577	4.441	5.545
IF 2018	0.393	1.054	2.153	3.619	5.009
dif	0.126	0.314	0.424	0.822	0.536
dif %	32%	30%	20%	23%	11%

What are top journals?

Examples of top journals (4* ABS)

Finance

ISSN	Field	Journal Title	AJG 2018
0022-1082	FINANCE	Journal of Finance	4*
0304-405X	FINANCE	Journal of Financial Economics	4*
0893-9454	FINANCE	Review of Financial Studies	4*

What are top journals?

Examples of top journals (4* ABS)

Marketing

ISSN	Field	Journal Title	AJG 2018
1057-7408	MKT	Journal of Consumer Psychology	4*
0093-5301	MKT	Journal of Consumer Research	4*
0022-2429	MKT	Journal of Marketing	4*
0022-2437	MKT	Journal of Marketing Research	4*
0092-0703	MKT	Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science	4*
0732-2399	MKT	Marketing Science	4*

What are top journals?

Examples of top journals (4* ABS)

General Interest Econ/Stats

ISSN	Field	Journal Title	AJG 2018
0002-8282	ECON	American Economic Review	4*
0090-5364	ECON	Annals of Statistics	4*
0012-9682	ECON	Econometrica	4*
0022-3808	ECON	Journal of Political Economy	4*
0033-5533	ECON	Quarterly Journal of Economics	4*
0034-6527	ECON	Review of Economic Studies	4*

What are top journals?

Examples of top journals (4* ABS)

Accounting

ISSN ?	Field	Journal Title
1558-7967	ACCOUNT	Accounting Review
1873-6289	ACCOUNT	Accounting, Organizations and Society
1879-1980	ACCOUNT	Journal of Accounting and Economics
1475-679X	ACCOUNT	Journal of Accounting Research

The journey of a paper

You got a unique idea and you write a paper about it. How (most) fields work?

What you got is a working paper, which must be polished in order to be published in a good journal. This happens by you presenting the paper at (good) conferences and also getting feedback from your friendly researchers.

The journey of a paper

ELSEVIER

Research in International Business and Finance

Volume 54, December 2020, 101255

Profit status of microfinance institutions and incentives for earnings management ☆

Rodrigo de Oliveira Leite [a, b], Layla dos Santos Mendes [b], Rafael de Lacerda Moreira [c]

Show more

https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ribaf.2020.101255

We thank the audience and participants for their comments at the 2018 Meeting of the Brazilian Finance Society, 2018 Meeting of the Brazilian Academy of Management, 2018 Meeting of the Brazilian Econometric Society, 2019 American Accounting Association Mid-Atlantic Region Meeting and the 2019 Journal of Accounting, Auditing and Finance Conference. We also thank seminar participants at FGV/EBAPE, especially Profs. Lars Norden, Fabio Caldieraro, Ricardo Lopes, and José Fajardo. We acknowledge the support from Higher Personnel Advancement Coordination (CAPES) – Finance Code 001, and the Getulio Vargas Foundation (FGV).

The journey of a paper

Now you are ready to submit. How to choose the journal?

*Must have a fit with the field

*Must have a fit with the methodology

*Must have a fit with the implications

The journey of a paper

*Desk review (by an editor)
*First round: 1-4 reviewers (usually blind or double-blind)

Possible outcomes:

*Desk reject
*Reject
*Major Revision (also called R&R, there is also risky R&R)
*Minor Revision
*Conditionally Acceptance
*Accept

The journey of a paper

You will be rejected. I just published twice in my first choice of journal (curiously they were my first two papers, and this has never happened since them, probably it was just beginner’s luck), all other papers were previously rejected.

Reviewers can be (really) tough and unfair.

An example (1)

As you will see, we are attaching two external reviews. One recommends a revise and resubmit. The other recommends accept with revisions. Given this feedback, and after careful consideration, the editors have unfortunately decided not to accept the paper for publication.

An example (2)

Associate Editor:

This is a hard decision, but given the positive qualities of your paper, I am recommending a major revision without any implications about the future acceptance of the paper. The referee reports are detailed, clear, and very useful. Hence, I will not repeat them here. If you consider resubmitting the paper, please incorporate all the comments and provide us with a response to every comment to be sent to the referees. I do see potential but there is a way to go to the desired destination.

Editor-in-Chief:

Thank you for submitting your manuscript to [redacted] I have now heard back from two referees and the handling editor. Unfortunately, even though both reviewers liked the topic, the comments were fairly negative. After re-reading the paper and both reports, I ultimately decided to reject the paper

The journey of a paper

Eg: My paper published in Accounting Forum (2025)

Got the idea in 2018, written the paper in 2018/19. Submitted to conferences in 2019. Submitted to several journals in 2020/21 and it was rejected, submitted to AF in 2021, after 5(!) rounds it was accepted in 2023 and published in 2025.

7 years since idea to publication

The journey of a paper

Sometimes the review time can be long.

My paper published in IJFE waited 10 months for the first round. Also, my first paper published in FRL has 5 pages but was in review at FRL for 9 months (more months than pages!)

This varies among journals and fields.

Open Access

Beware of that, most OA journals that charge a fee are “predatory”.

“Predatory” is the term academics use to say about “pay to publish”, these journals usually have no serious peer review method and approve very subpar papers.

But there are good OA journals

Open Access

The “good” journals (all of them have IFs)

*Frontiers in Psychology
*Scientific Reports
*Royal Society Open
*Sage Open
*PLOS One (dying a [very] slow death)

Beware of OA journals that are not cited above.

What constitutes a good paper?

*Unique dataset

*Interesting RQ

*Gap in the literature

What constitutes a good paper?

THE JOURNAL OF FINANCE • VOL. LV, NO. 2 • APRIL 2000

Trading Is Hazardous to Your Wealth: The Common Stock Investment Performance of Individual Investors

BRAD M. BARBER and TERRANCE ODEAN*

ABSTRACT

Individual investors who hold common stocks directly pay a tremendous performance penalty for active trading. Of 66,465 households with accounts at a large discount broker during 1991 to 1996, those that trade most earn an annual return of 11.4 percent, while the market returns 17.9 percent. The average household earns an annual return of 16.4 percent, tilts its common stock investment toward high-beta, small, value stocks, and turns over 75 percent of its portfolio annually. Overconfidence can explain high trading levels and the resulting poor performance of individual investors. Our central message is that trading is hazardous to your wealth.

Fees and Types of Journals

*OA journals usually charge a publishing fee

*Economics and Finance journals usually charge a submission fee

Types of journals

*General interest (e.g. QJE, JoF, MS, JMR, etc)

*Field journals (e.g. JME, JCF, AMLE, JIM, etc)

*Letters journals (e.g. EL, RiE, FRL, ML, etc)

Questions?